

The energy usage of AI image generation is highly exaggerated

Posted by u/Reverse_Necromancer • • 0 points • 57 comments

With the generous assumption that a drawing software uses the same energy as web surfing or watching videos, one image generated with the least efficient model would be equal to around 3 hours of digital drawing with the 13in iPad Air. Or if we take the mean value it's equal to around 48 minutes

Of course this is still a very rough estimate and it doesn't clearly address the training phase of AI nor the actual time used to draw an artwork and the variety of device artist use. I'm not arguing which is more energy friendly, but it does put perspective on the whole environment aspect of AI image generation

Comments

u/Character_Club_6461 • 1 points • 2026-02-01 10:14 UTC

Ok but the 2nd image is literally an ai summarisation which has a massive chance of being wrong so don't use that lmaoo

Also it's the water usage mostly.. Ai will have used a trillion (TRILLION do you know how much that is?!?) gallons of water by 2027. Like come on

u/Reverse_Necromancer • 1 points • 2026-02-01 10:50 UTC

>Ok but the 2nd image is literally an ai summarisation which has a massive chance of being wrong so don't use that lmaoo

I checked that number myself, you're welcome to do the same thing instead of "hurr durr it's AI it's wrong". I used that because it allows me to use one image for it

Do YOU know how much is a trillion? Do you know how many trillions of gallons of freshwater used for beef production for example? Humans don't even need beef to survive so do you have no problem with that? Or just compare to any other luxury that you enjoy but is not necessary, coffee, almond, chocolate, wine, swimming pools, lawns. Heck even paper, just look up how Many gallons the paper industry uses. Even the loss from "leaks" wastes a shit ton of water.

And that number is literally a speculation, why not compare to how much it used on 2025? Not even a fifth of that

u/Character_Club_6461 • 1 points • 2026-02-19 22:09 UTC

Heyy, I never said it WAS wrong!! I said there was a massive CHANCE of it being wrong and using ai to defend ai really doesn't work. That was my point. I wasn't saying it was an incorrect stat XD

Also, the water thing.. Suuuuure other things use tonnes of water too!! But that's actually useful. Now I can accept using text-ai because we've gone past the stage of getting rid of it and it can be used as a tool IF used correctly (it mostly isn't).

But ai images?? Why are we allowing people to waste THAT much water just to deepfake and pretend they have better art 'skills' than they really have. At least beef, coffee, almonds, chocolate, wine, swimming pools, paper, and lawns have a use to them. Ai images are quite literally pointless!! The food you can eat. The swimming pools and lawns you can exercise in, the lawn you can grow plants in.

Ai images destroy our environment, even if it's only by a little bit and to the same degree as other everyday items do, but it's worse because it's for a completely lazy, avoidable, and simple task

And don't even try telling me ai images can be useful, because I haven't seen one thing a person can't do that ai can. I can't find a single thing an ai can do better than a human, especially not consistently, when it comes to generating images. And trust me, I HAVE looked. I don't like debating without knowing the other sides pov too :>

I'd love to hear what you have to say back. Honestly I'm finding this a pretty fun debate so far!! Sorry I didn't type back very soon, I don't use reddit often

u/Reverse_Necromancer • 1 points • 2026-02-20 00:45 UTC

>I said there was a massive CHANCE of it being wrong and using ai to defend ai really doesn't work.

Like I said, you can just verify this "chance" yourself, and that itself proves that it does work

What exactly is your metric of being useful or useless? Here's one thing an AI can do that human can't, create a detailed image within seconds. People don't really need a mona Lisa for their everyday lives. Some just need a simple imagery for what they are thinking.

Like I mentioned it's not even to the same degree for some things on our everyday life. And guess what, all of those things I mentioned are all avoidable and unnecessary. Better alternatives are available yet you don't seem to find it wrong even after given how destructive they are

You have a very narrow view of this entire topic. You keep claiming people are "mostly" doing it for this and that yet you provided zero evidence of your claims.

u/Character_Club_6461 • 1 points • 2026-02-24 10:55 UTC

Alright sorry for the horrible grammar and structuring you're about to go through, I'm really ill right now :D

For usefulness/uselessness, I see whether AI is being used as a tool or as a replacement. It is useful if used as a tool to help humans. It is useless as a replacement for their learning. Knowledge is power, a phrase many people know, and it is true; using AI means the knowledge you possess gets no practise and so your skills are useless (does that make sense to you?? Im not sure i phrased that well). Sure you can use AI to replace human jobs like create a super detailed image in a few seconds, but you constantly have to rewrite prompts to get the image just the way you want (yes i have gone through and tried ai image creation myself so I know this is the case, no matter how detailed the prompt), whereas with an artist, photoshopper, or just by yourself you can create an image exactly as you wish, a lot more easily, and you also get the joy and satisfaction of a piece well done. At least your work hasn't been created via scrapping hundreds of non-consenting artists work as well.

Also you yourself said not everybody needs a Mona Lisa, a simple image will do. A simple image is so much easier to do via sketching and 100x more rewarding too. It's your own work, something you can be proud of. With ai it is soulless and there is nothing in the work that can tell the audience about you. The audience includes friends btw i dont mean audience in terms of tv shows etc

According to the Financial Marketer (since you wanted facts, and this site seems to even promote ai image usage so it should be seen as reliable on your end), "62% of marketers are now using generative AI to create new image assets, and 76% use it for general content creation" quote en quote. Soo going back to the first point abt tools vs replacements, most people are using it to replace human tasks (though tbf these stats will also include ppl using ai responsibly so take this with a pinch of salt here)

Even as a tool to learn, AI is fundamentally flawed, due to its inability to understand basic concepts the same way humans understand them. AI is dumb, just like any other computer- it reads code. It is limited to its recourses only and cannot learn in the human sense.

AI will 'learn' based off of sits the programmer wants it to learn off- lets say we want an AI to learn from Youtube. It will take ALL the information, both fake clickbait and true info, then take the most popular version of this information, which lets be real is probably going to be the clickbait people are not that smart online and will fall for curiosity even if they don't agree with it. The AI therefore believes the clickbait to be true. This is defo a more closed interpretation on AI but it works for what im saying - even as a tool, although it can be used occasionally with good outcomes - AI won't always be correct (every so often false information will become the truth for an AI like the chatgpt-seahorse emoji thing), so it is limited in its usefulness there too.

I will say, for context, that I live around artists. I am an artist. My life revolves around communities of artists, and even my dad is an artist. Most of the ai images I am exposed to, due to cookies and the way the online world works, is ai where people are using it to create images of their own (this is why I say AI is mostly doing certain things- that's my personal experience and what I found to be true, even if it is not true for you).

OK i'm SO sorry you had to read through all that (if you did, that is). My thoughts are very jumbly rn.. as you can probably tell :)
Ask if anything doesn't make sense ill try to explain a lil better when im not ill

u/2007100710 • 1 points • 2025-08-15 18:54 UTC

I have a Instagram account with 55K Followers. I Need someone to create some AI good Pictures. Can you help with this and I can pay You if the results is Good.

u/CommonAcanthaceae325 • 1 points • 2025-08-15 14:06 UTC

Source?

u/Reverse_Necromancer • 1 points • 2025-08-15 14:11 UTC

<https://arxiv.org/pdf/2311.16863.pdf>

u/Due_Sky_2436 • 1 points • 2025-08-09 18:14 UTC

Uh oh, now there are numbers involved. Some self styled creative people going to get much mad. /s

The Anti-AI crowd are not going to be swayed by any amount of facts. Only submitting to their world view will get them to shut up... oh wait, not even that because then the culture will force you to complain loudly to your own compatriots about the other side even existing.

Best choice when dealing with anti-ai types is to ignore, or just engage for a bit when you need a laugh.